100 Idioms & Phrases – MCQ Practice

Competitive / Placement Exam Style • Solution immediately below every question

How to use: Try each question first, then read the explanation. The solution explains the correct idiom and why the other three options do not fit.

1. The school administration found the bullying complaint to be _____.

A. a feather in his cap
B. a hot potato
C. a piece of cake
D. a bed of roses

Answer: B. a hot potato
Meaning: a sensitive or controversial issue.
Why other options are wrong: A. a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **C.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **D.** a bed of roses → a very easy or pleasant situation.

2. The basic coding question was _____ for the experienced candidate.

A. a storm in a teacup
B. a wild goose chase
C. a piece of cake
D. a hot potato

Answer: C. a piece of cake
Meaning: something very easy.
Why other options are wrong: A. a storm in a teacup → a lot of fuss about a small matter. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

3. Life in a new city is not always _____.

A. a red herring
B. a hot potato
C. a white elephant
D. a bed of roses

Answer: D. a bed of roses
Meaning: a very easy or pleasant situation.
Why other options are wrong: A. a red herring → something that misleads or distracts. **B.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue. **C.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project.

4. The abandoned stadium became _____ because it cost millions to maintain.

A. a white elephant
B. a piece of cake
C. a silver lining
D. a red-letter day

Answer: A. a white elephant
Meaning: an expensive but useless possession or project.
Why other options are wrong: B. a piece of cake → something very easy. **C.** a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation. **D.** a red-letter day → a very important or memorable day.

5. The clue about the old car was _____ and sent the detective in the wrong direction.

A. a piece of cake
B. a red herring
C. a feather in his cap
D. a bed of roses

Answer: B. a red herring
Meaning: something that misleads or distracts.
Why other options are wrong: A. a piece of cake → something very easy. **C.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **D.** a bed of roses → a very easy or pleasant situation.

6. Missing that flight was _____ because she met her future employer later.

A. a wet blanket
B. a wild goose chase
C. a blessing in disguise
D. a hot potato

Answer: C. a blessing in disguise
Meaning: something that seems bad but has a good result.
Why other options are wrong: A. a wet blanket → a person who spoils others' enjoyment. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

7. Their argument turned out to be _____ and ended quickly.

A. a white elephant
B. a red-letter day
C. a piece of cake
D. a storm in a teacup

Answer: D. a storm in a teacup
Meaning: a lot of fuss about a small matter.
Why other options are wrong: A. a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project. **B.** a red-letter day → a very important or memorable day. **C.** a piece of cake → something very easy.

8. The false address sent the police on _____.

A. a wild goose chase
B. a silver lining
C. a feather in his cap
D. a bed of roses

Answer: A. a wild goose chase
Meaning: a pointless search.
Why other options are wrong: B. a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation. **C.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **D.** a bed of roses → a very easy or pleasant situation.

9. The noisy neighbour became _____ for the family.

A. a blessing in disguise
B. a thorn in the flesh
C. a red-letter day
D. a piece of cake

Answer: B. a thorn in the flesh
Meaning: a persistent source of annoyance.
Why other options are wrong: A. a blessing in disguise → something that seems bad but has a good result. **C.** a red-letter day → a very important or memorable day. **D.** a piece of cake → something very easy.

10. The unpaid bill became _____ between the partners.

A. a silver lining

B. a white elephant

C. a bone of contention

D. a hot potato

Answer: C. a bone of contention
Meaning: a subject causing disagreement.
Why other options are wrong: A. a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation. **B.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

11. Winning the national award was _____ for the young scientist.

A. a wet blanket

B. a red herring

C. a storm in a teacup

D. a feather in his cap

Answer: D. a feather in his cap
Meaning: an achievement to be proud of.
Why other options are wrong: A. a wet blanket → a person who spoils others' enjoyment. **B.** a red herring → something that misleads or distracts. **C.** a storm in a teacup → a lot of fuss about a small matter.

12. The company's first international launch was _____.

A. a red-letter day

B. a wild goose chase

C. a piece of cake

D. a hot potato

Answer: A. a red-letter day
Meaning: a very important or memorable day.
Why other options are wrong: B. a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **C.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

13. His constant complaints made him _____ at the party.

A. a red herring

B. a wet blanket

C. a feather in his cap

D. a silver lining

Answer: B. a wet blanket
Meaning: a person who spoils others' enjoyment.
Why other options are wrong: A. a red herring → something that misleads or distracts. **C.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **D.** a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation.

14. The only _____ was that nobody was injured in the accident.

A. a bone of contention

B. a wild goose chase

C. a silver lining

D. a white elephant

Answer: C. a silver lining
Meaning: a positive aspect of a difficult situation.
Why other options are wrong: A. a bone of contention → a subject causing disagreement. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project.

15. We have finished the main task, so let's _____.

A. spill the beans

B. jump the gun

C. burn bridges

D. call it a day

Answer: D. call it a day
Meaning: stop working for the day.
Why other options are wrong: A. spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** jump the gun → act too soon. **C.** burn bridges → destroy a relationship or possibility of returning.

16. The trainer told a joke to _____ at the beginning of the workshop.

A. break the ice

B. cut corners

C. miss the boat

D. bite the bullet

Answer: A. break the ice
Meaning: make people feel more comfortable.
Why other options are wrong: B. cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps. **C.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity. **D.** bite the bullet → face a difficult situation bravely.

17. The analyst _____ when she identified poor planning as the main cause.

A. pull someone's leg

B. hit the nail on the head

C. beat around the bush

D. throw in the towel

Answer: B. hit the nail on the head
Meaning: identify something exactly.
Why other options are wrong: A. pull someone's leg → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** beat around the bush → avoid saying something directly. **D.** throw in the towel → give up.

18. Stop _____ and tell me what actually happened.

A. going cold turkey

B. hitting the sack

C. beating around the bush

D. calling the shots

Answer: C. beating around the bush
Meaning: avoid saying something directly.
Why other options are wrong: A. going cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** hitting the sack → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** calling the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

19. Ravi accidentally _____ about the surprise party.

A. cut the mustard

B. kept his powder dry

C. hit the jackpot

D. spilled the beans

Answer: D. spilled the beans
Meaning: reveal a secret.
Why other options are wrong: A. cut the mustard → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** kept his powder dry → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable.

20. He _____ just before giving his first public speech.

A. got cold feet

B. called it a day

C. brought home the bacon

D. saw eye to eye

Answer: A. got cold feet

Meaning: become nervous before doing something.

Why other options are wrong: B. called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** brought home the bacon → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** saw eye to eye → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

21. She decided to _____ and pay the unexpected repair bill.

A. break the bank

B. bite the bullet

C. miss the boat

D. pull the plug

Answer: B. bite the bullet
Meaning: face a difficult situation bravely.
Why other options are wrong: A. break the bank → cost a very large amount. **C.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity. **D.** pull the plug → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

22. I did not want to attend, but my friends _____.

A. hit the sack

B. read the riot act

C. twisted my arm

D. cut corners

Answer: C. twisted my arm
Meaning: persuade someone.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the sack → go to bed. **B.** read the riot act → strongly reprimand or warn. **D.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps.

23. Don't _____; the mistake can be corrected easily.

A. keep an eye on

B. call it a day

C. go the extra mile

D. make a mountain out of a molehill

Answer: D. make a mountain out of a molehill
Meaning: exaggerate a small problem.
Why other options are wrong: A. keep an eye on → watch carefully. **B.** call it a day → stop working for the day. **C.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

24. The two managers do not always _____ on financial matters.

A. see eye to eye

B. throw in the towel

C. go bananas

D. draw a blank

Answer: A. see eye to eye
Meaning: agree completely.
Why other options are wrong: B. throw in the towel → give up. **C.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** draw a blank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

25. I am exhausted, so I am going to _____ early.

A. hit the nail on the head

B. hit the sack

C. hit the roof

D. hit the jackpot

Answer: B. hit the sack
Meaning: go to bed.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly. **C.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **D.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable.

26. Please _____ and tell us whether the proposal was accepted.

A. put on airs

B. spill the beans

C. cut to the chase

D. beat around the bush

Answer: C. cut to the chase
Meaning: get to the main point.
Why other options are wrong: A. put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **B.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** beat around the bush → avoid saying something directly.

27. His angry reply only _____ during the argument.

A. kept the wolf from the door

B. broke the ice

C. called it a day

D. added fuel to the fire

Answer: D. added fuel to the fire
Meaning: make a bad situation worse.
Why other options are wrong: A. kept the wolf from the door → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

28. After several failed attempts, the team decided to _____.

A. throw in the towel

B. test the waters

C. call the shots

D. keep an eye on

Answer: A. throw in the towel
Meaning: give up.
Why other options are wrong: B. test the waters → try something cautiously first. **C.** call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** keep an eye on → watch carefully.

29. You should _____ the claims made in that advertisement.

A. break the bank

B. take them with a grain of salt

C. hit the sack

D. go the extra mile

Answer: B. take them with a grain of salt
Meaning: not accept something as completely true.
Why other options are wrong: A. break the bank → cost a very large amount. **C.** hit the sack → go to bed. **D.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

30. Ignoring the safety warning is _____.

A. calling it a day

B. keeping the ball rolling

C. playing with fire

D. seeing eye to eye

Answer: C. playing with fire
Meaning: take a dangerous risk.
Why other options are wrong: A. calling it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** keeping the ball rolling → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** seeing eye to eye → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

31. She was _____ after receiving the scholarship.

A. under the weather

B. in hot water

C. at a loss

D. on cloud nine

Answer: D. on cloud nine
Meaning: extremely happy.
Why other options are wrong: A. under the weather → feeling unwell. **B.** in hot water → in trouble. **C.** at a loss → confused or unsure what to do.

32. I am feeling _____ today and will stay home.

A. under the weather

B. on cloud nine

C. in the red

D. in black and white

Answer: A. under the weather
Meaning: feeling unwell.
Why other options are wrong: B. on cloud nine → extremely happy. **C.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **D.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented.

33. Please _____ the equipment while I speak to the supervisor.

A. jump the gun

B. keep an eye on

C. spill the beans

D. burn bridges

Answer: B. keep an eye on
Meaning: watch carefully.
Why other options are wrong: A. jump the gun → act too soon. **C.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** burn bridges → destroy a relationship or possibility of returning.

34. The resignation came _____ and surprised everyone.

A. in the red

B. once in a blue moon

C. out of the blue

D. by the book

Answer: C. out of the blue
Meaning: unexpectedly.
Why other options are wrong: A. in the red → in financial loss or debt. **B.** once in a blue moon → very rarely. **D.** by the book → according to the rules.

35. He visits his hometown only _____.

A. at the drop of a hat

B. through thick and thin

C. by leaps and bounds

D. once in a blue moon

Answer: D. once in a blue moon
Meaning: very rarely.
Why other options are wrong: A. at the drop of a hat → immediately, without hesitation. **B.** through thick and thin → through good and bad times. **C.** by leaps and bounds → very rapidly.

36. The company has been _____ since last year.

A. in the red
B. on the ball
C. in the pink
D. under wraps

Answer: A. in the red
Meaning: in financial loss or debt.
Why other options are wrong: B. on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **C.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** under wraps → kept secret.

37. The officer always does everything _____.

A. under the table
B. by the book
C. out of the blue
D. at sea

Answer: B. by the book
Meaning: according to the rules.
Why other options are wrong: A. under the table → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** out of the blue → unexpectedly. **D.** at sea → confused or uncertain.

38. The agreement is there _____ in the contract.

A. on thin ice
B. out of the blue
C. in black and white
D. through thick and thin

Answer: C. in black and white
Meaning: in writing or clearly documented.
Why other options are wrong: A. on thin ice → in a risky situation. **B.** out of the blue → unexpectedly. **D.** through thick and thin → through good and bad times.

39. The new assistant is really _____ and rarely misses a detail.

A. under a cloud
B. in a pickle
C. at a loss
D. on the ball

Answer: D. on the ball
Meaning: alert and quick to understand.
Why other options are wrong: A. under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **B.** in a pickle → in a difficult situation. **C.** at a loss → confused or unsure what to do.

40. The employee was _____ after violating the safety rules.

A. in hot water
B. on cloud nine
C. in the pink
D. off the hook

Answer: A. in hot water
Meaning: in trouble.
Why other options are wrong: B. on cloud nine → extremely happy. **C.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** off the hook → free from blame or responsibility.

41. We are all _____ because the deadline has been moved forward.

A. in black and white

B. in the same boat

C. on the ball

D. under wraps

Answer: B. in the same boat
Meaning: in the same difficult situation.
Why other options are wrong: A. in black and white → in writing or clearly documented. **C.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **D.** under wraps → kept secret.

42. The board decided to _____ the failed project.

A. bring home the bacon

B. test the waters

C. pull the plug on

D. keep the ball rolling

Answer: C. pull the plug on
Meaning: stop or terminate.
Why other options are wrong: A. bring home the bacon → earn money to support a family. **B.** test the waters → try something cautiously first. **D.** keep the ball rolling → keep a process going.

43. Let's approve the next step to _____.

A. throw in the towel

B. hit the roof

C. cut corners

D. keep the ball rolling

Answer: D. keep the ball rolling
Meaning: keep a process going.
Why other options are wrong: A. throw in the towel → give up. **B.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **C.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps.

44. I cannot _____ this noise any longer.

A. put up with

B. go cold turkey

C. miss the boat

D. call the shots

Answer: A. put up with
Meaning: tolerate.
Why other options are wrong: B. go cold turkey → stop a habit suddenly and completely. **C.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity. **D.** call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

45. Both parents work hard to _____.

A. jump the gun

B. bring home the bacon

C. beat a dead horse

D. break the ice

Answer: B. bring home the bacon
Meaning: earn money to support a family.
Why other options are wrong: A. jump the gun → act too soon. **C.** beat a dead horse → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** break the ice → make people feel more comfortable.

46. There is no use _____ after the mistake has happened.

A. calling the shots

B. going the extra mile

C. crying over spilt milk

D. cutting corners

Answer: C. crying over spilt milk
Meaning: regret something that cannot be changed.
Why other options are wrong: A. calling the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** going the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** cutting corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

47. Many companies _____ and started offering AI tools.

A. hit the sack

B. went under the weather

C. called it a day

D. jumped on the bandwagon

Answer: D. jumped on the bandwagon
Meaning: join a popular trend.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the sack → go to bed. **B.** went under the weather → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

48. The support team always _____ to help customers.

A. goes the extra mile

B. cuts corners

C. misses the boat

D. throws in the towel

Answer: A. goes the extra mile
Meaning: make an additional effort.
Why other options are wrong: B. cuts corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** misses the boat → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** throws in the towel → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

49. Apply now or you may _____.

A. keep your chin up

B. miss the boat

C. break the ice

D. hit the jackpot

Answer: B. miss the boat
Meaning: lose an opportunity.
Why other options are wrong: A. keep your chin up → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** break the ice → make people feel more comfortable. **D.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable.

50. It is wiser to _____ than reopen the dispute.

A. call the shots
B. spill the beans
C. let sleeping dogs lie
D. open a can of worms

Answer: C. let sleeping dogs lie
Meaning: avoid restarting an old conflict.
Why other options are wrong: A. call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** open a can of worms → create a complicated set of problems.

51. The audit _____ several hidden accounting errors.

A. put on airs
B. ran out of steam
C. went cold turkey
D. brought to light

Answer: D. brought to light
Meaning: reveal or discover.
Why other options are wrong: A. put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **B.** ran out of steam → lost energy or enthusiasm. **C.** went cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

52. He tends to _____ when important guests arrive.

A. put on airs
B. keep an eye on
C. hit the sack
D. make ends meet

Answer: A. put on airs
Meaning: behave as if one is more important.
Why other options are wrong: B. keep an eye on → watch carefully. **C.** hit the sack → go to bed. **D.** make ends meet → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

53. The campaign _____ after several months.

A. called the shots
B. ran out of steam
C. hit the jackpot
D. broke the ice

Answer: B. ran out of steam
Meaning: lose energy or enthusiasm.
Why other options are wrong: A. called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **D.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

54. The supervisor _____ for repeatedly arriving late.

A. put him on ice

B. let him off the hook

C. took him to task

D. gave him the green light

Answer: C. took him to task
Meaning: strongly criticize or reprimand.
Why other options are wrong: A. put him on ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** let him off the hook → release him from blame or punishment. **D.** gave him the green light → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

55. The proposal _____ because it ignored traditional safety practices.

A. hit the sack

B. made ends meet

C. cut the mustard

D. went against the grain

Answer: D. went against the grain
Meaning: conflict with usual beliefs or preferences.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the sack → go to bed. **B.** made ends meet → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** cut the mustard → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

56. The board finally _____ to the construction plan.

A. gave the green light

B. put a lid on

C. held its horses

D. called the shots

Answer: A. gave the green light
Meaning: give permission to proceed.
Why other options are wrong: B. put a lid on → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** held its horses → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

57. The committee decided to _____ the proposal until next month.

A. go bananas

B. put the proposal on ice

C. bring home the bacon

D. hit the roof

Answer: B. put the proposal on ice
Meaning: postpone something.
Why other options are wrong: A. go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** bring home the bacon → earn money to support a family. **D.** hit the roof → became extremely angry.

58. _____! We need to verify the figures first.

A. Cut corners
B. Break the bank
C. Hold your horses
D. Spill the beans

Answer: C. Hold your horses
Meaning: wait or be patient.
Why other options are wrong: A. Cut corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** Break the bank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** Spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

59. Buying the top model will _____.

A. hit the roof
B. cut to the chase
C. draw a blank
D. break the bank

Answer: D. break the bank
Meaning: cost a very large amount.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the roof → became extremely angry. **B.** cut to the chase → get to the main point. **C.** draw a blank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

60. Dad will _____ when he sees the damaged car.

A. hit the roof
B. hit the sack
C. hit the jackpot
D. hit the nail on the head

Answer: A. hit the roof
Meaning: become extremely angry.
Why other options are wrong: B. hit the sack → go to bed. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **D.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly.

61. When asked for the password, I _____.

A. went the extra mile

B. drew a blank

C. hit the jackpot

D. called it a day

Answer: B. drew a blank
Meaning: be unable to remember or find an answer.
Why other options are wrong: A. went the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **D.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

62. The small company _____ with its new app.

A. cut to the chase

B. was under the weather

C. hit the jackpot

D. went cold turkey

Answer: C. hit the jackpot
Meaning: have great success or obtain something valuable.
Why other options are wrong: A. cut to the chase → get to the main point. **B.** was under the weather → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** went cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

63. He decided to _____ and stop using social media.

A. call the shots

B. put on airs

C. burn bridges

D. go cold turkey

Answer: D. go cold turkey
Meaning: stop a habit suddenly and completely.
Why other options are wrong: A. call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **C.** burn bridges → destroy a relationship or possibility of returning.

64. As project leader, Maya _____.

A. calls the shots

B. cries over spilt milk

C. runs out of steam

D. misses the boat

Answer: A. calls the shots
Meaning: make important decisions.
Why other options are wrong: B. cries over spilt milk → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** runs out of steam → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** misses the boat → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

65. You are _____ after ignoring the manager's final warning.

A. in the clear

B. on thin ice

C. on cloud nine

D. in the pink

Answer: B. on thin ice
Meaning: in a risky situation.
Why other options are wrong: A. in the clear → free from danger, blame, or difficulty. **C.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **D.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

66. The details of the new product are still _____.

A. in the red

B. out of the blue

C. under wraps

D. in the same boat

Answer: C. under wraps
Meaning: kept secret.
Why other options are wrong: A. in the red → in financial loss or debt. **B.** out of the blue → unexpectedly. **D.** in the same boat → in the same difficult situation.

67. The investigation proved that the employee was _____.

A. in hot water

B. at sea

C. in a pickle

D. in the clear

Answer: D. in the clear
Meaning: free from danger, blame, or difficulty.
Why other options are wrong: A. in hot water → in trouble. **B.** at sea → confused or uncertain. **C.** in a pickle → in a difficult situation.

68. I was _____ when the computer suddenly stopped working.

A. at a loss

B. on the ball

C. over the moon

D. in black and white

Answer: A. at a loss
Meaning: confused or unsure what to do.
Why other options are wrong: B. on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **C.** over the moon → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented.

69. We were _____ when the only car broke down.

A. at the drop of a hat

B. in a pickle

C. on the mend

D. in the pink

Answer: B. in a pickle
Meaning: in a difficult situation.
Why other options are wrong: A. at the drop of a hat → immediately, without hesitation. **C.** on the mend → recovering from illness or injury. **D.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

70. After the operation, he is slowly _____.

A. under wraps

B. in the red

C. on the mend

D. on thin ice

Answer: C. on the mend
Meaning: recovering from illness or injury.
Why other options are wrong: A. under wraps → kept secret. **B.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **D.** on thin ice → in a risky situation.

71. The students were _____ after hearing the good news.

A. at loggerheads

B. under a cloud

C. in a fix

D. in high spirits

Answer: D. in high spirits
Meaning: cheerful and happy.
Why other options are wrong: A. at loggerheads → in strong disagreement. **B.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **C.** in a fix → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

72. The two departments are _____ over the budget.

A. at loggerheads

B. on the ball

C. in the pink

D. under wraps

Answer: A. at loggerheads
Meaning: in strong disagreement.
Why other options are wrong: B. on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **C.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** under wraps → kept secret.

73. The official remained _____ after the investigation.

A. a piece of cake

B. under a cloud

C. on cloud nine

D. in high spirits

Answer: B. under a cloud
Meaning: under suspicion or facing disgrace.
Why other options are wrong: A. a piece of cake → something very easy. **C.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **D.** in high spirits → cheerful and happy.

74. The first exercise was _____.

A. a close shave

B. a wild goose chase

C. as easy as pie

D. a storm in a teacup

Answer: C. as easy as pie
Meaning: very easy.
Why other options are wrong: A. a close shave → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a storm in a teacup → a lot of fuss about a small matter.

75. True friends stay together _____.

A. at the drop of a hat
B. by leaps and bounds
C. under the table
D. through thick and thin

Answer: D. through thick and thin
Meaning: through good and bad times.
Why other options are wrong: A. at the drop of a hat → immediately, without hesitation. **B.** by leaps and bounds → very rapidly. **C.** under the table → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

76. She is ready to travel _____.

A. at the drop of a hat
B. by the book
C. in black and white
D. once in a blue moon

Answer: A. at the drop of a hat
Meaning: immediately, without hesitation.
Why other options are wrong: B. by the book → according to the rules. **C.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented. **D.** once in a blue moon → very rarely.

77. The company's online sales have grown _____.

A. in a pickle
B. by leaps and bounds
C. under a cloud
D. at loggerheads

Answer: B. by leaps and bounds
Meaning: very rapidly.
Why other options are wrong: A. in a pickle → in a difficult situation. **C.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **D.** at loggerheads → in strong disagreement.

78. The two runners were _____ near the finish line.

A. in the red
B. off the hook
C. neck and neck
D. under the weather

Answer: C. neck and neck
Meaning: very close or equal in a competition.
Why other options are wrong: A. in the red → in financial loss or debt. **B.** off the hook → free from blame or responsibility. **D.** under the weather → feeling unwell.

79. The company will _____ before launching nationally.

A. spill the beans
B. hit the sack
C. put on airs
D. test the waters

Answer: D. test the waters
Meaning: try something cautiously first.
Why other options are wrong: A. spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** hit the sack → go to bed. **C.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important.

80. Never _____ when dealing with electrical safety.

A. cut corners

B. keep an eye on

C. go the extra mile

D. call it a day

Answer: A. cut corners

Meaning: do something cheaply or carelessly by skipping proper steps.

Why other options are wrong: B. keep an eye on → watch carefully. **C.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** call it a day → stop working for the day.

81. The mediator tried to _____ between the two teams.

A. throw in the towel

B. smooth things over

C. hit the roof

D. miss the boat

Answer: B. smooth things over
Meaning: reduce tension or resolve disagreement.
Why other options are wrong: A. throw in the towel → give up. **C.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **D.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity.

82. After breaking the rules, he had to _____.

A. jump the gun

B. go bananas

C. face the music

D. keep the wolf from the door

Answer: C. face the music
Meaning: accept the consequences.
Why other options are wrong: A. jump the gun → act too soon. **B.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** keep the wolf from the door → have enough money for basic needs.

83. She works two jobs to _____.

A. hit the jackpot

B. break the bank

C. pull someone's leg

D. keep the wolf from the door

Answer: D. keep the wolf from the door
Meaning: have enough money for basic needs.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **B.** break the bank → cost a very large amount. **C.** pull someone's leg → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

84. Do not _____ before the official announcement.

A. jump the gun

B. call it a day

C. hit the sack

D. go the extra mile

Answer: A. jump the gun
Meaning: act too soon.
Why other options are wrong: B. call it a day → stop working for the day. **C.** hit the sack → go to bed. **D.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

85. The crowd _____ when the singer appeared.

A. called the shots

B. went bananas

C. kept its cards close

D. was in the red

Answer: B. went bananas
Meaning: become very excited or behave wildly.
Why other options are wrong: A. called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** kept its cards close → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** was in the red → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

86. The negotiator _____ during the talks.

A. broke the ice

B. called it a day

C. kept his cards close to his chest

D. hit the nail on the head

Answer: C. kept his cards close to his chest
Meaning: keep one's intentions secret.
Why other options are wrong: A. broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly.

87. Relax! I was only _____ when I said I had resigned.

A. cutting corners

B. calling the shots

C. throwing in the towel

D. pulling your leg

Answer: D. pulling your leg
Meaning: tease or joke with someone.
Why other options are wrong: A. cutting corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** calling the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** throwing in the towel → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

88. The coach _____ after the team ignored instructions.

A. read the riot act

B. kept the ball rolling

C. went cold turkey

D. took it with a grain of salt

Answer: A. read the riot act
Meaning: strongly reprimand or warn.
Why other options are wrong: B. kept the ball rolling → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** went cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** took it with a grain of salt → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

89. The old machine no longer _____.

A. keeps the wolf from the door

B. cuts the mustard

C. breaks the ice

D. hits the sack

Answer: B. cuts the mustard
Meaning: meet the required standard.
Why other options are wrong: A. keeps the wolf from the door → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** breaks the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** hits the sack → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

90. The evidence proved she was _____.

A. on thin ice
B. under a cloud
C. off the hook
D. in hot water

Answer: C. off the hook
Meaning: free from blame or responsibility.
Why other options are wrong: A. on thin ice → in a risky situation. **B.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **D.** in hot water → in trouble.

91. Without the instructions, the new employee was completely _____.

A. on cloud nine
B. in the clear
C. under wraps
D. at sea

Answer: D. at sea
Meaning: confused or uncertain.
Why other options are wrong: A. on cloud nine → extremely happy. **B.** in the clear → free from danger, blame, or difficulty. **C.** under wraps → kept secret.

92. He was _____ after failing the final interview.

A. down in the dumps
B. in the pink
C. on the ball
D. in the clear

Answer: A. down in the dumps
Meaning: sad or unhappy.
Why other options are wrong: B. in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **D.** in the clear → free from danger, blame, or difficulty.

93. The new measures may _____ future attacks.

A. break the ice
B. ward off
C. spill the beans
D. pull the plug on

Answer: B. ward off
Meaning: prevent or avoid something undesirable.
Why other options are wrong: A. break the ice → make people feel more comfortable. **C.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** pull the plug on → stop or terminate.

94. The evidence seems to _____ her version of events.

A. call it a day
B. put on airs
C. bear out
D. cut corners

Answer: C. bear out
Meaning: confirm or support.
Why other options are wrong: A. call it a day → stop working for the day. **B.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **D.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps.

95. Please _____ the report before submitting it.

A. hit the roof

B. throw in the towel

C. go bananas

D. go over

Answer: D. go over
Meaning: review or examine carefully.
Why other options are wrong: A. hit the roof → became extremely angry. **B.** throw in the towel → give up. **C.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

96. The date of the event is still _____.

A. up in the air

B. in black and white

C. on cloud nine

D. by the book

Answer: A. up in the air
Meaning: undecided or uncertain.
Why other options are wrong: B. in black and white → in writing or clearly documented. **C.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **D.** by the book → according to the rules.

97. The sudden cancellation _____ the entire team.

A. brought home the bacon

B. threw the entire team into a tailspin

C. put on airs

D. kept the ball rolling

Answer: B. threw the entire team into a tailspin
Meaning: put someone into confusion or disorder.
Why other options are wrong: A. brought home the bacon → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **D.** kept the ball rolling → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

98. My old laptop finally _____ during the presentation.

A. called the shots

B. hit the nail on the head

C. gave up the ghost

D. broke the ice

Answer: C. gave up the ghost
Meaning: stop working or die.
Why other options are wrong: A. called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly. **D.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

99. The negotiator decided to _____ until more evidence appeared.

A. jump the gun

B. spill the beans

C. cut the mustard

D. keep his powder dry

Answer: D. keep his powder dry
Meaning: remain prepared and avoid acting too soon.
Why other options are wrong: A. jump the gun → act too soon. **B.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** cut the mustard → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

100. The extra practice helped _____ the lost time.

A. make up for

B. put on airs

C. run out of steam

D. draw a blank

Answer: A. make up for
Meaning: compensate for something.
Why other options are wrong: B. put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **C.** run out of steam → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** draw a blank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.